

Jiawei Fan

Brandeis University | Ph.D. Candidate in Financial Economics

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EDUCATION

Brandeis University, Waltham, MA, USA	2022 - present
<i>PhD Candidate in International Economics and Finance</i>	
University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong, China	2021 – 2022
<i>MA in Economics</i>	
Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA, USA	2015 – 2017
<i>MA in Statistics</i>	
South China University of Technology, Guangzhou, China	2011 – 2015
<i>BA in Applied Mathematics</i>	

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Asset pricing, Financial Economics, Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

Two Heads Are Better Than One: t-Statistics and Monotonicity in the Factor Zoo

(Job Market Paper, sole-authored)

This paper shows that two in-sample diagnostics used to judge factor quality the conventional t-statistic and monotonicity capture distinct information and enhance predictive power when combined. The two measures are nearly un-correlated in-sample ($\rho = -0.08$). Factors with the highest in-sample summed rank across both dimensions (≥ 70 th percentile) deliver 33.4/34.2 bps/month in out-of-sample return/alpha, while factors with the lowest summed rank (≤ 30 th percentile) deliver only 10.2/10.9 bps/month. High-summed-rank factors also perform better in real-time trading: a strategy built on the top 30% by summed rank dominates on a certainty-equivalent basis at every risk-aversion level considered and continues to hold up once trading costs and market impact are priced in. Finally, the combined strategy results in higher diversification in factor rotation. [\[SSRN Link\]](#)

Calendar Effects of Asset Pricing Factors, with Sida Li and Wanyu Miao

The literature finds that U.S. equity returns are higher overnight, on Fridays, in January, around the turn-of-the-month, and during macro announcements (e.g., FOMC, GDP, NFP, and ISM releases). We replicate 153 long-short factors and find that their premia are lower in all of these periods. On average, a factor loses 2.01 bps overnight but earns 5.45 bps intraday ($t = 8.54$); earns 5.77 bps on Mondays, 3.44 bps on midweek days, and 1.24 bps on Fridays (midweek–Monday difference: $t = -7.06$; Friday–midweek difference: $t = -5.34$); earns 0.22 bps in January but 3.71 bps on non-January days ($t = 3.66$); earns 1.89 bps during turn of-the-month days versus 3.61 bps on other days ($t = 6.01$); earns 2.99 bps during three-day windows surrounding major macroeconomic announcements, compared with 3.71 bps on other days ($t = 4.62$). The results are robust in-sample and out-of-sample. Our results are consistent with sentiment-driven mispricing, as we find that the calendar effects of factors are stronger when news sentiment is high. [\[SSRN Link\]](#)

Presented at: Chinese Economists Society (CES) China Annual Conference 2026

Stale Data, Persistent Alpha, with Sida Li

Anomaly returns concentrate around information releases, suggesting mispricing that is corrected as news arrives. We replicate 94 accounting-based anomalies with accounting data lagged by up to five years. Alpha decays slowly: median

monthly CAPM alphas are 36 basis points at the four-month lag and 28 with year-old data, robust out of sample and positive internationally. An equal-weighted book of year-old factors earns 19 basis points monthly ($t = 4.9$); the four-month minus-twelve-month spread earns 8 ($t = 6.0$) and is shrinking. The evidence limits explanations in which returns vanish once information is public and is consistent with a persistent characteristic premium. [\[SSRN Link\]](#)

PAPER PRESENTATIONS

Chinese Economists Society (CES) China Annual Conference 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Brandeis University	Fall 2025
<i>Statistics for Economic Analysis</i> by Tymon Słoczyński	
Teaching Assistant, Brandeis University	Fall 2025
<i>Introduction to Machine Learning with Economic Applications</i> by Yinchu Zhu	
Teaching Assistant, Brandeis University	Fall 2024
<i>Applied Econometrics with R</i> by Davide Pettenuzzo	
Teaching Assistant, Brandeis University	Spring 2023
<i>Introduction to Natural Language Processing</i> by Yeabin Moon	
Teaching Assistant, Lehigh University	Fall 2016
<i>Calculus III</i> by Terry Napier	

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Brandeis Online Learning Lab	2023 - present
Senior Associate, KMK Consulting Inc.	2017 – 2021
<i>Publications:</i> Real-World Treatment Patterns Among Patients with Mycosis Fungoides or Sezary Syndrome in the United States	
with Yang Zhao, Jackson Tang, Huanxue Zhou. Published in ISPOR 2021, <i>Value in Health</i> , Volume 24, Issue 5, S1 (May 2021) [Publication Link]	

GRANTS, AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS

Brandeis University Doctoral Fellowship	2022-2027
Provost Doctoral Research Award	2025
Institute of Education Sciences Grant	2024
Third Prize in Mathematical Contest in Modeling (COMAP)	2014
Second Prize in Mathematical Contest in Modeling (COMAP)	2013

LANGUAGES & TOOLS

Programming and Scripting Languages	R, Python, SQL, SAS, Matlab
Machine Learning Tools	PyTorch, TensorFlow, Scikit-learn
Dashboarding & Visualization Tools	Tableau
Languages	Chinese (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

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Professor Sida Li

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Professor Anna Scherbina

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